

20 PAYWALLS THAT **ACTUALLY** CONVERT.

Screen-level design patterns and flow-level monetization practices from top-grossing subscription apps — every entry backed by a published A/B test, revenue-verified analysis, or platform benchmark, with sources.

%

+23%

trial sign-ups from Blinkist's transparent trial-timeline paywall

2*

2.9*

higher conversion for animated paywalls vs. static designs

80

80%+

of in-app purchases happen on the first paywall screen

SELECTION WAS DATA, **NOT** TASTE.

A**DOCUMENTED EXPERIMENTS**

Entries like Blinkist (+23% trials), FitnessAI (revenue doubled) and Alpe Audio (3× trials) come from published A/B tests with before/after funnel numbers reported by the teams who ran them — not from screenshots judged on looks.

B**REVENUE-VERIFIED APPS**

Part II leans on ScreensDesign/Superwall analysis of apps with verified monthly revenue — Flo (\$9M/mo), Calm (\$4M/mo), YAZIO (\$3.3M/mo), Speak (\$2.8M/mo), SCRL (\$2M/mo), Finch (\$1.8M/mo). These patterns are running in production at scale, funding real businesses.

C**CROSS-SOURCE VALIDATION**

Patterns had to appear in at least two independent sources. The trial timeline is confirmed separately by Growth.Design, Purchasely and RevenueCat; social proof by Superwall, FunnelFox and Corrily; win-back economics by Apple, RevenueCat and Appbot.

!**ONE HONEST CAVEAT**

Practitioners who copied the Blinkist timeline did not always reproduce the +23% lift — widely adopted patterns hit diminishing returns. Benchmarks reflect each app's traffic mix and positioning. Everything here is a hypothesis to test, not a guarantee.

PART I: SCREEN & FLOW FUNDAMENTALS.



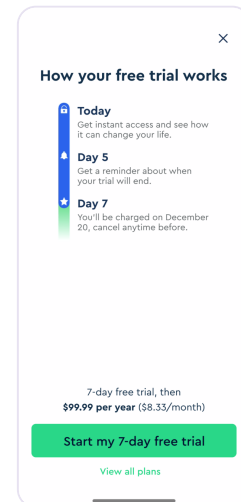
The ten practices from the first research pass: trial transparency, price anchoring, plan architecture, social proof, product-led paywalls, placement, reminder flows, win-backs and segmentation — each tied to a named app and a measured result.

01

BLINKIST

TRIAL TIMELINE · "THE HONEST PAYWALL"

A timeline showing exactly how the trial works — what unlocks today, a reminder on day 5, billing on day 7 — replaced the classic feature-list paywall. Results: **+23% trial sign-ups**, a **1,200%** jump in notification opt-in (6%→74%), **55% fewer** complaints and +4% trial retention. **Why it works:** user research showed the #1 hesitation was fear of forgetting to cancel — 33% of cancellations happened immediately after trial start. The winning screen mentioned no features at all; its only job was killing that fear.



Winning variant B — the trial timeline
growth.design/case-studies/trial-paywall-challenge

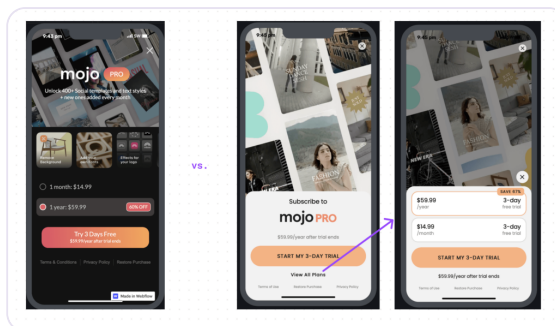
Sources: [Growth.Design case study \(growth.design/case-studies/trial-paywall-challenge\)](https://growth.design/case-studies/trial-paywall-challenge) · B2B Pricing Insights · Purchasely teardown

02

MOJO

MONTHLY-EQUIVALENT PRICE ANCHORING

Mojo reframed its annual plan as **"\$4.99/month billed annually"** instead of "\$59.99/year." This single language change produced a **significant lift in revenue per paywall impression** — strongest in lower-income regions — via higher conversion and more annual sign-ups. **Compliance note:** Apple requires the real annual cost to stay visible ("\$59.99/year — that's just \$4.99/month" is fine; hiding annual billing behind a monthly breakdown is a rejection risk).



Mojo Pro paywall — annual plan pricing A/B variants · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/paywall-tests-grow-app-revenue

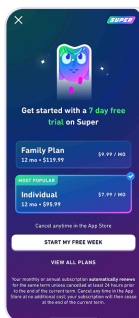
Sources: [RevenueCat — "8 paywall test ideas to grow app revenue" \(Jake Mor\)](https://revenuecat.com/blog/growth/paywall-tests-grow-app-revenue) · Adaptey iOS Paywall Design Guide

03

DUOLINGO

"BEST VALUE" BADGE + DECOY TIER

Duolingo visually emphasizes a "Best Value" tier flanked by less compelling plans — users gravitate to the one that feels like the smarter deal. In a documented decoy test, adding a strategically inferior "Pro" tier lifted conversions of the target middle plan by **+20%**. Separately, a "Most Popular" ribbon on a large-font annual plan preserves price-anchoring lifts while staying inside Apple's rules. **Why it works:** users don't evaluate price in a vacuum — they compare, and the decoy makes the target plan the obvious "aha" choice.



Duolingo Super paywall · blog.funnelfox.com/effective-paywall-screen-designs-mobile-apps

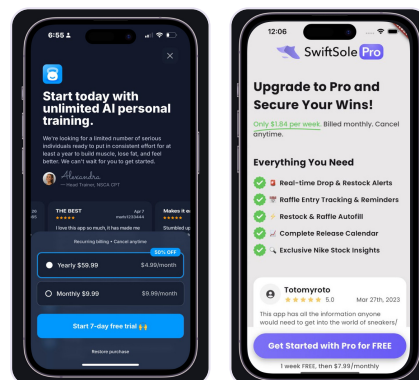
Sources: Apphud — "Pricing Psychology for Subscription Apps" · RevenueFlo — iOS paywall compliance analysis

04

PLANZERA & SWIFTSOLE

SOCIAL PROOF ON THE PAYWALL ITSELF

Planzera embeds happy user reviews directly in the paywall, reinforcing the plan's core promise (hitting training goals) at the exact moment of decision. SwiftSole pairs review social proof with the selected plan's price shown in weekly terms at the top and the word "FREE" capitalized in its CTA. **Why it works:** reviews, ratings and media logos transfer trust; benefit-driven CTAs ("Start my plan") outperform generic "Subscribe."



Planzera (left) and SwiftSole (right) paywalls
superwall.com/blog/20-ios-paywalls-in-production

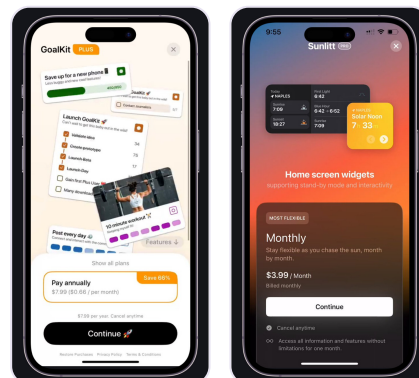
Sources: Superwall — "20 live iOS paywalls and what to learn from them" · Funnelfox paywall UX guide

05

GOALKIT & SUNLITT

"UI CHUNK" — THE PRODUCT INSIDE THE PAYWALL

Goalkit places recognizable pieces of the live app UI inside the paywall; Sunlitt embeds an actual widget — its core differentiator — right on the screen. **Why it works:** the paywall stops describing value and starts showing it. Related benchmark: animated paywalls convert **~2.9× better** than static ones, and video teasers should hook in the first 3 seconds, run 15–30s, and carry text overlays for muted devices.



Goalkit (left) and Sunlitt (right) paywalls
superwall.com/blog/20-ios-paywalls-in-production

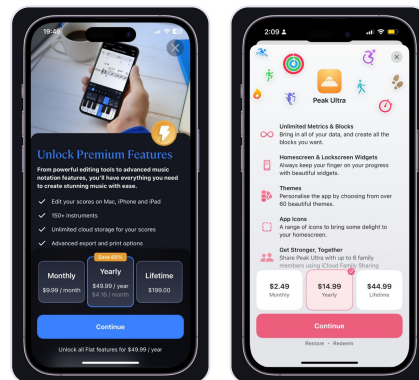
Sources: Superwall — "20 live iOS paywalls" · Adapty 2026 paywall trends · Apphud — "Best-performing paywalls"

06

FLAT & PEAK

EVERYTHING ON ONE SCREEN — NO SCROLLING

Flat shows all plans and core benefits with zero scrolling, and prints the monthly-equivalent price under its yearly offer. Peak fuses a compact feature list with all pricing options. **Why it works:** most paywalls force a choice between plans or benefits plus scrolling; removing that work removes drop-off. Keep benefits specific and skimmable — 3–5 points, "reach your goal 3× faster," not "premium content" — and tuck secondary plans into a "View all plans" drawer.



Flat (left) and Peak (right) paywalls
superwall.com/blog/20-ios-paywalls-in-production

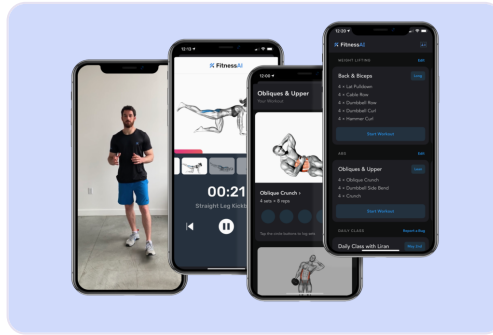
Sources: Superwall — "20 live iOS paywalls" · FunnelFox paywall UX guide · Nami — 2023 paywall trends

07

FITNESSAI & ALPE AUDIO

FLOW: PAYWALL PLACEMENT BEFORE ONBOARDING

FitnessAI moved its paywall before onboarding and added a feature video: **50% more users** saw the paywall, install-to-trial doubled, trial-to-paid held steady — **revenue doubled**. Alpe Audio saw an immediate **3× trials** from the same move. Beyond the main paywall, Mojo's app-open triggered campaign generated 15% of new iOS revenue with minimal complaints. **Why it works:** over 80% of purchases happen on the first paywall — install intent is high but fleeting, and every onboarding step before the paywall bleeds it.



FitnessAI's pre-onboarding paywall flow · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/paywall-tests-grow-app-revenue

Sources: RevenueCat — "8 paywall test ideas" · Indie Hackers — Alpe Audio (+7.6× free-to-paid) · RevenueCat mobile paywall guide (Mojo)

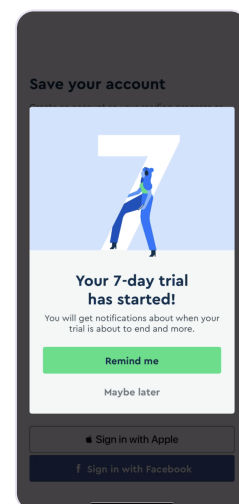
08

BLINKIST FLOW

FLOW: KEEP THE REMINDER PROMISE

The timeline screen (#01) only converts because the flow behind it is real: a push/email reminder fires days before trial conversion. That promise-kept mechanism reduced complaints by **55%** and cut cancellations during trial.

Why it works: the timeline is the promise; the day-5 reminder is the mechanism. Standard implementation today is a webhook (trial_started) → delayed reminder via email/push — no backend needed with RevenueCat + Zapier or equivalent.



The kept promise — trial-expiry notification opt-in
growth.design/case-studies/trial-paywall-challenge

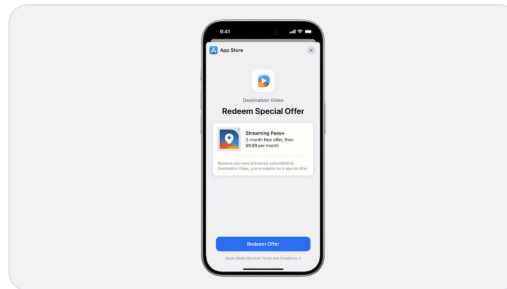
Sources: RevenueCat — "How to build a Blinkist-style paywall using webhooks and Zapier" · Growth.Design case study

09

WIN-BACKS

FLOW: TIMING BEATS DISCOUNT DEPTH

Up to **20% of monthly churned users** resubscribe within 12 months — most apps simply have no strategy for them. Re-engagement probability decays sharply: users churned within 30 days convert far better than those lapsed 6+ months, so recent churners should get the lowest-friction offer fast (email deep link → paywall pre-loaded with the promotional offer; reactivation in under 30 seconds). At the cancellation moment itself, an in-flow offer cuts churn by **~32% on average** (up to 45%), and in-flow messaging retains **2.4×** better than static screens — now natively supported by Apple's Retention Messaging API and StoreKit win-back offers. One team found annual subscribers flipped billing status around day 290 — so they targeted day 280.



StoreKit win-back offer sheet · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/guide-to-apple-win-back-offers

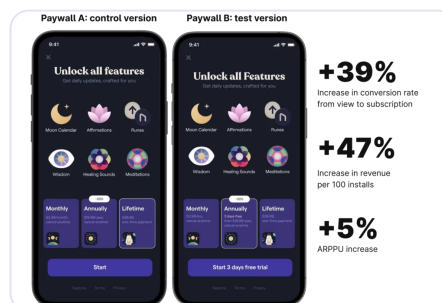
Sources: RevenueCat — State of Subscription Apps & win-back guides · Appbot — Retention Messaging API analysis · AppsOps — promotional offer mechanics · Apple App Store Connect docs

10

SEGMENTATION

FLOW: DYNAMIC PAYWALLS, NOT ONE STATIC SCREEN

Dynamic paywalls with segmented or time-based offers convert **~35% higher** than static ones. Leading apps vary the experience by segment (paid UA vs. organic), behavior and predicted intent. Seasonal offers tied to events (Black Friday, in-app events) work — but always A/B test a **no-offer variant**: Mojo found no offer sometimes won outright in the US market.



Moonly — A/B-tested paywall variants per segment · adapty.io/blog/how-to-design-ios-paywall

Sources: Adapty — 2026 paywall design guide · RevenueCat — mobile paywall guide (Mojo Black Friday experiments)

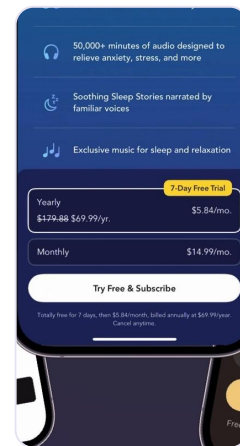
PART II: MILLION-DOLLAR PATTERNS.

Ten more paywalls, mostly from apps with verified monthly revenue in the millions: anchoring at Calm, testimonial engineering at Flo and YAZIO, stacked proof at Speak, urgency at Finch, discount framing at SCRL, plan grids at Spotify, scarcity at Noom, goal segmentation at Headspace, and the trial toggle at Rizz.

11

CALM · \$4M/MO**HIGH MONTHLY ANCHOR → SINGLE ANNUAL OFFER**

Calm anchors users with a deliberately high monthly price, making the annual plan's effective monthly cost look dramatically better. In onboarding, a multi-step quiz builds a personalized recommendation, then lands on a paywall with a **single annual offer** and a "Try Free" button — monthly is removed as a distraction. **Why it works:** anchoring sets the reference point; removing the second choice removes decision friction at the moment of highest intent.



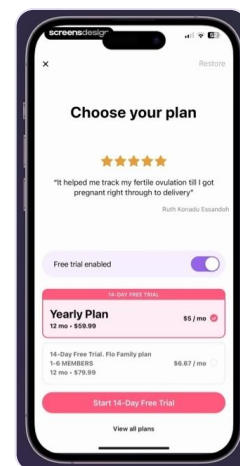
Calm — yearly anchor vs. monthly
superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

Sources: Superwall — "5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps" (ScreensDesign revenue data) · Superwall — "What is a mobile app paywall"

12

FLO · \$9M/MO**ONE POWERFUL, RELATABLE TESTIMONIAL**

Flo — one of the highest-grossing health apps — places a single relatable, emotionally resonant user testimonial directly on its paywall rather than a wall of reviews. **Why it works:** at **2.3M+ monthly installs**, one well-chosen voice that mirrors the target user builds more trust than generic star counts. Testable variants: one testimonial vs. many, user count vs. quote, generic vs. hyper-specific numbers.



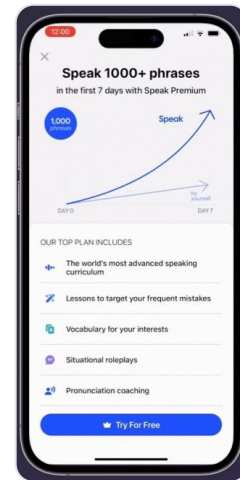
Flo — single testimonial on the paywall
superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

Sources: Superwall — "5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps" (ScreensDesign revenue data)

13

SPEAK · \$2.8M/MO**STACKED SOCIAL PROOF**

Speak layers multiple proof types on one paywall: **5M+ users**, a **4.8-star rating**, and **140,000+ reviews**. Each element answers a different doubt — popularity, quality, volume of evidence. **Why it works:** stacking converts skeptics that a single proof point misses. Worth testing: "Join millions" vs. hyper-specific "Join 5,432,187 users" — specificity can itself increase trust.



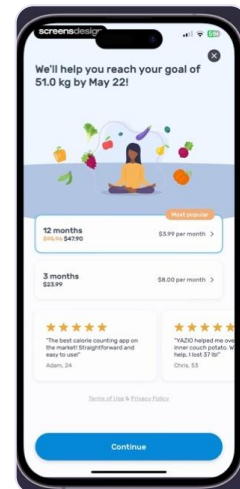
Speak — stacked proof on the paywall
superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

Sources: Superwall — "5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps" (ScreensDesign revenue data)

14

YAZIO · \$3.3M/MO**GAMIFIED URGENCY + TESTIMONIALS**

YAZIO runs a "spin the wheel" mechanic that awards a one-time **"75% OFF FOREVER"** offer — urgency built into the nature of the reward: it exists now, and disappears if unused. Beneath the main offer, multiple testimonials with star ratings reinforce value. **Why it works:** the user "earned" the discount, which raises perceived value and makes walking away feel like a loss (endowment effect). Test discount believability too: a massive 90% off can convert worse than a trustworthy 50%.



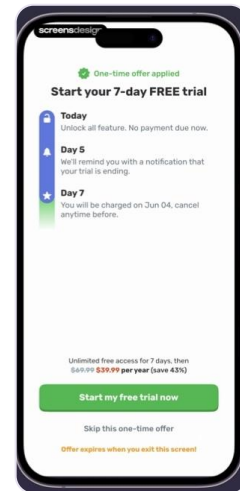
YAZIO — offer with testimonials below
superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

Sources: Superwall — "5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps" (ScreensDesign revenue data)

15

FINCH · \$1.8M/MO**EXIT-BASED URGENCY**

Finch states plainly at the bottom of its paywall: **"Offer expires when you exit this screen."** No countdown theatrics — a single, credible, screen-bound deadline. **Why it works:** the deadline is verifiably real (leave and it's gone), which sidesteps the trust damage of fake timers. Test urgency types against each other: static "ends today" copy vs. live countdown vs. exit-bound offers.



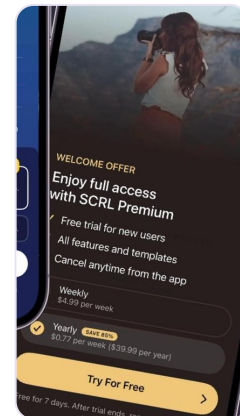
Finch — exit-bound offer deadline
superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

Sources: Superwall — "5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps" (ScreensDesign revenue data)

16

SCRL · \$2M/MO**DISCOUNT FRAMING: "SAVE 85%"**

SCRL headlines a massive **"SAVE 85%"** on its yearly plan, framed against the weekly price — making the annual commitment feel trivially cheap by comparison. **Why it works:** weekly pricing creates a high implicit anchor; the savings percentage does the math for the user. Test the banner copy ("Best Value" vs. "Most Popular" vs. "Save N%"), which plan gets emphasis, and total-price vs. effective-monthly display.



SCRL — "SAVE 85%" yearly framing
superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

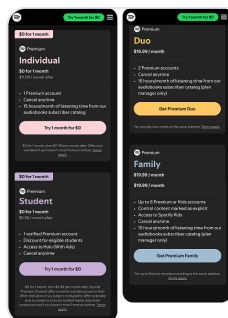
Sources: Superwall — "5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps" (ScreensDesign revenue data)

17

SPOTIFY

PLAN SEGMENTATION GRID

Spotify presents Premium as a clean grid — Individual, Student, Duo, Family — each card leading with "**\$0 for 1 month**" and repeating "Cancel anytime." Every plan targets a distinct audience with its benefits spelled out. **Why it works:** segmentation lets users self-select by life situation instead of by price tolerance; the \$0 hook and cancel-anytime promise kill the two biggest objections up front. Weakness worth avoiding: dense legal fine print on the cards dilutes the friendly tone.



Spotify Premium plan grid · blog.funnelfox.com/effective-paywall-screen-designs-mobile-apps

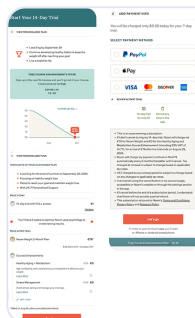
Sources: Funnelfox — "Engaging Paywall Screens for Apps" (Spotify breakdown)

18

NOOM

PAID LOW-COST TRIAL + RESERVED-PLAN SCARCITY

Noom's landing-page-style paywall combines a **\$0.50–\$1 paid trial** (a micro-commitment that filters for intent), a timeline preview of expected progress on "your personalized plan," and scarcity: the reserved plan expires in 15 minutes. **Why it works:** at Noom's premium price point, the flow sells a personalized outcome, not features — and the micro-payment produces far higher-intent trialists than free. Anti-pattern to note: the full post-trial price is buried in fine print, a trust cost Noom pays for it.



Noom — paid-trial paywall with reserved plan · blog.funnelfox.com/effective-paywall-screen-designs-mobile-apps

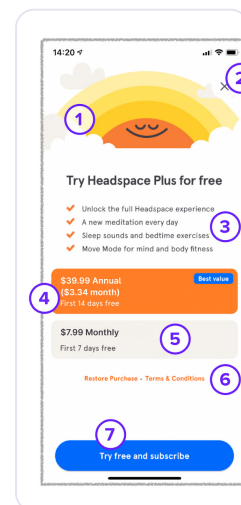
Sources: Funnelfox — Noom paywall breakdown · RevenueCat — "7 Ways to Make Your Paywall Do More Than Sell"

19

HEADSPACE

GOAL-SEGMENTED MESSAGING + GRACEFUL CANCELLATION

Headspace tailors paywall messaging to the user's declared goal — stress relief vs. better sleep — so the pitch matches the motivation. Its annual upsell frames the commitment as **"building a practice takes time,"** selling long-term value rather than just savings. And its cancellation instructions are deliberately clear and easy to find. **Why it works:** segment-matched messaging converts better than generic pitches; the retention-first annual framing attracts subscribers who stay; graceful cancellation builds the trust that drives resubscription.



Headspace — "Try Headspace Plus for free"
adapty.io/blog/how-to-design-ios-paywall

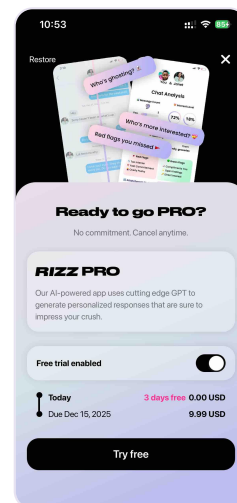
Sources: Corrilly — "10 Practical Examples to Optimize Subscription Paywalls" · RevenueCat — Rosie Hoggmascall interviews

20

RIZZ

FREE-TRIAL TOGGLE + HIDDEN TIME CONSTRAINT

Rizz's payment card carries a trial on/off toggle: default shows a 7-day free trial; flipping it lets no-trial users pay immediately (often with a discount). Crucially, the team also removed the trial length from the selection card itself — users saw the timeline visually above, but at the decision point the label just said "free," eliminating the "what if I forget to cancel in 3 days?" spike of anxiety. Related finding from 4,500 paywall tests: a radically simplified paywall — image, headline, one button — beat a detailed comparison chart by **111%**. Users don't read; don't make them.



RIZZ PRO — "Free trial enabled" toggle + timeline
paywallscreens.com/apps/rizz-mobile-paywall-b3cd

Sources: Superwall — "\$50M no-code apps paywall" (Vahe interview) · Superwall — "The paywall tactics behind \$100K/month apps" (Jonathan Parra, 4,500 tests)

FULL SOURCE LIST

EVERY CLAIM, TRACEABLE.

Growth.Design — Trial Paywall Challenge (Blinkist A/B test) · growth.design/case-studies/trial-paywall-challenge

Superwall — 5 Paywall Patterns Used By Million-Dollar Apps · superwall.com/blog/5-paywall-patterns-used-by-million-dollar-apps

Superwall — 20 Live iOS Paywalls · superwall.com/blog/20-ios-paywalls-in-production

Superwall — The Paywall Tactics Behind \$100K/Month Apps (4,500 tests) · superwall.com/blog/the-paywall-tactics-behind-usd100k-month-apps

Superwall — \$50M No-Code Apps Paywall (trial toggle) · superwall.com/blog/our-no-code-apps-made-usd50m-using-this-paywall

RevenueCat — 8 Paywall Test Ideas to Grow App Revenue · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/paywall-tests-grow-app-revenue

RevenueCat — Guide to Apple Win-Back Offers · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/guide-to-apple-win-back-offers

RevenueCat — How to Win Back Lost Customers · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/win-back-customers-how-to-guide

RevenueCat — Blinkist-Style Paywall with Webhooks + Zapier · revenuecat.com/blog/engineering/how-to-build-a-blinkist-style-paywall-using-revenuecat-webhooks-and-zapier

RevenueCat — Guide to Mobile Paywalls (Mojo experiments) · revenuecat.com/blog/growth/guide-to-mobile-paywalls-subscription-apps

Adapty — iOS Paywall Design Guide 2026 (animation, dynamic paywall benchmarks) · adapty.io/blog/how-to-design-ios-paywall

Apphud — Pricing Psychology for Subscription Apps (decoy, anchoring) · apphud.com/blog/subscription-pricing-psychology

FunnelFox — Engaging Paywall Screens (Spotify, Noom, Duolingo breakdowns) · blog.funnelfox.com/effective-paywall-screen-designs-mobile-apps

Appbot — Apple Retention Messaging API (cancellation-flow churn data) · appbot.co/blog/win-back-apple-subscribers

Corrily — 10 Practical Paywall Optimization Examples (Headspace) · corrily.com/blog/optimize-paywall-strategies-examples

Indie Hackers — Alpe Audio: 7.6× Free-to-Paid · indiehackers.com/post/how-we-increased-conversion-from-free-to-paid-by-7-6x-e067256502